

Vibe Connect — Setup

Enable, sign in, and configure Vibe Connect on your Vibe Appliance.

Vibe Appliance setup guide · built 2026-08-31 · generated from the app's manifest · KisaesDevLab/Vibe-Appliance

1. What this app is

Secure document and message exchange between firm and clients.

App id (slug)	vibe-connect
Uses	the appliance's shared postgres — nothing separate to install
Data lives in	database <code>vibe_connect_db</code> inside the appliance's Postgres — covered by your Duplicati backups and by the automatic pre-update dump

2. Before you enable it

- The appliance itself must be installed and healthy — see the **Vibe Appliance setup guide** first if you haven't done that yet.
- Each running app uses memory. Two or three apps fit a 2 GB server; for all of them plan on 4 GB or more.
- If the card shows an image not published badge, the app's build isn't available yet — the Enable button stays off until it is.

3. Enable the app

1. Open the admin console and scroll to **Apps**.
2. On the **Vibe Connect** card, click **Enable**.
3. Watch the badge: `not-installed` → `enabling...` → `running`. This usually takes a minute or two (first enable pulls the app's images).

Behind the button, the appliance creates the app's database and a restricted database user, writes the app's configuration file from a template, starts its containers, and only reports **running** once the app's own health check answers that it is fully ready. If enabling fails, the card shows the error with a recovery hint — fix the cause and click Enable again; re-running is always safe.

4. Open it and sign in

Domain mode	<code>https://vibe.<your-domain>/connect/</code> (replace <code>vibe</code> with your tunnel subdomain if you changed it)
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LAN mode	<code>http://<host>.local/connect/</code>
Tailscale mode	<code>http://<tailnet-ip>/connect/</code>
client portal	<code>https://client.<your-domain>/</code> (domain mode)

The exact live URL for your install is always shown on this app's card in the admin console — use that if in doubt.

Open the app URL. The first-login credentials are shown in the admin console under **First-login info**.

5. Setup on Windows

There is nothing to install on Windows for this app — it runs on the appliance server, and you use it from a browser (Microsoft Edge or Chrome, as your firm prefers). What follows is the Windows side of reaching it in each mode.

- **Domain mode:** just open the URL from the previous section. The certificate is real, so there is nothing to click through.
- **LAN mode:** recent Windows 10 and 11 resolve `<host>.local` addresses out of the box, but some office networks and VPN clients block that discovery traffic. If the `.local` address doesn't load, use the server's IP address instead: `http://<server-ip>/connect/`. The exact working URL is always shown on this app's card in the admin console.
- **Tailscale mode:** install the Tailscale app for Windows from `tailscale.com/download`, sign in to the firm's tailnet, and the tailnet URL from the section above works. The Tailscale icon in the system tray shows whether you're connected.
- **Bookmark it:** once the right URL loads, save it as a browser favorite (Ctrl+D) — or let your IT person pin it via a browser shortcut on each staff desktop.

6. Settings

Everything required (database, cache, secrets, URLs) is generated automatically when you enable the app. The settings below are the ones you may need to fill in yourself. Find them in the admin console under **Settings**, on the tab named in the left column.

Network tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Subdomain	The <code><subdomain></code> in <code><subdomain>.<your-domain></code> for this app when routing is 'subdomain per app' (see Network settings). Leave blank to use the built-in default. Lowercase letters, digits, and dashes; no dots. Saving re-renders routing and re-provisions the Cloudflare Tunnel; the app briefly restarts.

Email & SMS tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Email provider	Without email, Vibe-Connect's client portal is disabled. Pick a provider, fill the credentials, click Test, then Save.
From address	e.g. noreply@firm.com — must be verified with your email provider's sending-domain settings.
Resend API key secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	Starts with re_. Generate at https://resend.com/api-keys (Sending Access scope is enough).
Postmark server token secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	Per-server token (UUID-shaped). Find at https://account.postmarkapp.com under Servers → API Tokens. Use a token from a Transactional Stream — Broadcast tokens are rejected for one-off sends.
EmailIt API key secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	Starts with em_ (live or test). Create one at https://emailit.com under workspace Settings → API. Test keys land in the v2 sandbox; live keys deliver real mail.
SMTP host	Hostname only (no scheme), e.g. smtp.gmail.com or mail.example.com.
SMTP port	587 for STARTTLS (most providers). 465 for implicit TLS. 25 is plain SMTP and usually blocked outbound on cloud hosts.
SMTP username	Often the same as the From address. Gmail/Workspace requires an App Password — your account password won't authenticate.
SMTP password secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	Provider password or App Password (Gmail, Outlook, etc.). The Test button does a TCP-connect probe to verify host:port reachability — actual credential validation happens on first send.
SMS provider	Optional. Magic-link email is the primary 2FA path; SMS is a backup. Twilio is the canonical cloud provider; TextLink is a budget cloud SMS service that delivers through your own Android phone (the phone acts as the SIM).
Twilio auth token secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	32-character hex token paired with the Account SID. Find at https://console.twilio.com under Account → API keys & tokens (the primary auth token).
Twilio account SID	34 chars, starts with AC. Same dashboard as the auth token. Subaccount SIDs work — pair with that subaccount's auth token.
TextLink API base URL	Leave the default (https://textlinksms.com) unless you run TextLink Bridge on your own infrastructure. The /api/send-sms path is appended automatically.

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
TextLink API key secret — stored in the app's env file, never displayed again	Generate in the TextLink web console under API. Test sends a real SMS to the number you supply (uses one credit). The phone running the TextLink Android app must be online for delivery.

Backup tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
Backup destination	Encrypted backups of /opt/vibe/data and /opt/vibe/env. Configure the destination here, then complete authentication inside the Duplicati UI on its own subdomain.

Compliance tab

SETTING	WHAT TO ENTER
PII redaction confidence threshold	0.5–0.95. Tighter values redact less; loose values may redact non-PII text.
Step-up code TTL (seconds)	60–3600. Shorter is more secure; longer is more forgiving for slow inboxes.

7. Updates and rollback

- When a newer build is available, the card shows an **update available** badge. Click **Update**.
- Before updating, the appliance takes a database backup automatically. If the updated app fails its health check, it is rolled back to the previous version — and the **Roll back** button lets you do the same by hand.
- Updates are never automatic; nothing changes until you click.

8. If something goes wrong

- **Run the doctor first.** Admin console → **Doctor** → Run (or `sudo vibe doctor` on the server). It names the failing check and the fix.
- **Read the card.** Errors on the app card include a recovery hint; the output panel under the buttons shows the last action's log.
- **Emergency access.** If the normal URL is down but the app itself is running, `http://<server-ip>:5181/` reaches it directly, bypassing the web front end. Plain HTTP — use it from the LAN or Tailscale only, for getting back on your feet, not for daily work. (Staff emergency access only — client magic-link flows require HTTPS cookies and won't work over the plain-HTTP emergency port.) The client portal surface has its own emergency port: `http://<server-ip>:5182/`.
- **Disable / Enable** from the card restarts the app cleanly. Disabling never deletes data.

- Still stuck? `docs/TROUBLESHOOTING.md` in the appliance repository is keyed by symptom.